

Spling

A user-side ordering profile for AI assistants.

Owner: Laszlo Czako Entity: R-evolv Inc. Date: August 2, 2026 Status: Pre-build — supersedes spling-ios

01 What Spling Is

Spling is a Model Context Protocol (MCP) server that gives an AI assistant everything it needs to place a food or retail order *on behalf of a specific person* — their language, their order history, their allergens, their past corrections — and routes that order as clean structured data into the merchant's point-of-sale system.

It is not an ordering app. It is not a POS integration. It is the layer that carries **the customer** across merchants and across assistants.

ONE-LINE POSITIONING

Square made the merchant reachable by AI. Spling makes the customer legible to it.

02 The Problem

Ordering by voice at a drive-through or counter fails at a measurable rate. Human-operated drive-throughs average 80–85% order accuracy. Independent 2026 field testing put traditional drive-throughs at roughly 89% versus 83% for AI voice systems — meaning the industry's current answer has not yet beaten the humans it replaced.

The causes are acoustic and linguistic, not cognitive: engine and road noise, low-fidelity speaker hardware, accents, non-native speakers, speech differences, and disability. Every major vendor is attacking this by trying to *hear better* through a speaker in traffic.

Spling's counter-position: don't listen at all. If the order is composed on the customer's own device, in their own language, and transmitted as structured data, the acoustic channel — and every failure mode attached to it — is removed rather than improved.

03 Market Reality (as of August 2026)

This section exists so the build is scoped against what already shipped, not against a 2024 picture of the market.

WHAT SHIPPED	IMPLICATION FOR SPLING
Square × ChatGPT/Claude July 1, 2026	Restaurants accept orders directly through ChatGPT and Claude, auto-opt-in, processing fees only. Merchant-side distribution is solved and free. Do not rebuild it — build on it.
UCP (Google/Shopify) Jan 11, 2026	Open standard for agent-driven commerce end to end. Spling does not compete at the protocol layer.
ACP (OpenAI) + MCP	MCP is the shared connector standard across Claude and ChatGPT. One server serves both.
Instant Checkout deprecated March 2026	External checkout is the recommended path. Spling returns a payment link; it never touches card data.
QSR voice AI at scale	Taco Bell, Wendy's, McDonald's, Burger King all deployed. They own the merchant side of the acoustic problem. Spling owns the customer side, which none of them serve.

WHY SPLING-IOS IS RETIRED

The previous build (NFC tag reading, AI menu scraping from vendor HTML, direct POS webhooks) solved distribution problems that the protocol layer solved better between January and July 2026. Scraped menus go stale and are legally grey; NDEF tag reading is a context trigger, not a payment rail; per-merchant webhooks do not scale for a solo founder. **The concept survives. The implementation does not.**

04 Strategic Position

Every layer of this stack is owned by someone with more distribution than us, with exactly one exception.

- **Rails** — Square, Stripe. Owned. Ride them.
- **Protocol** — UCP, ACP, MCP. Owned. Conform to them.
- **Merchant relationships** — Square, Toast, Olo. Owned. Inherit them.
- **Assistant surface** — Anthropic, OpenAI. Owned. Plug into them.
- **The customer's portable profile** — *unowned*. No POS company has an incentive to build it, and no assistant retains it across vendors.

That last line is the entire business. Everything else in this document is in service of it.

MOAT THESIS

A profile the user owns and carries survives them switching from Claude to GPT to whatever comes next. Held on our server, we are a replaceable service. Held by the user and plugged in anywhere, we are infrastructure. Design for the second from commit one — even if v1 ships as the first.

05 Feature Set

A. Core ordering — required for v1

- Menu retrieval from a live merchant catalog (Square Catalog API — never scraped)
- Structured order composition with modifiers, quantities, and validation against real POS items
- Order submission into the merchant's POS
- Payment via external checkout link (Stripe / Square); no card data ever touches Spling
- Pickup code and order-status readback

B. Profile & memory — the product

- Order history across merchants, queryable by the assistant ("the usual")
- Allergen and dietary constraints applied automatically at order composition
- Speech and communication profile — for users with speech differences, this replaces the spoken channel entirely
- Receipt archive, structured and searchable
- Payment method preference
- Portable and user-owned by design; exportable

C. Language — the wedge

- Order composed in the user's language; structured line items delivered to the POS in the merchant's language
- Persistent language profile — set once, applies everywhere
- Receipts and history stored in the user's language, transacted in the local one
- Travel case: order and pay abroad without reading the local menu

D. Accuracy ledger — the compounding asset

- Two-way record: what was ordered vs. what arrived
- User-submitted corrections and critique tied to merchant, location, and item
- Per-merchant accuracy scoring accumulated over time
- **This is the dataset nobody holds.** Square sees the ticket; the merchant sees the complaint; nothing connects them across chains. It is also the evidence base for any future per-order pricing.

E. Deferred — explicitly not v1

- Native iOS app (Swift) — profile custody, Apple Pay, offline access
- Drive-through geofence detection and auto-context
- NFC tap-to-complete (requires Apple's paid NFC & Secure Element commercial agreement)
- Caregiver-staged ordering
- Picture-based menu interface
- Multi-channel queue prioritization

06 Architecture

LAYER	TECHNOLOGY	NOTES
MCP server	TypeScript / Deno on Supabase Edge Functions	The product. Same runtime pattern as Rooted's 13 edge functions — directly reusable knowledge.
Transport	Remote HTTPS only	ChatGPT does not accept stdio servers. Hosted endpoint is mandatory, not optional.
Auth	OAuth 2.1 + Dynamic Client Registration	Bearer tokens are not accepted by ChatGPT. This is a hard requirement, not a nice-to-have.
Data	Supabase Postgres, RLS-enforced	Profile, history, receipts, accuracy ledger.
Merchant rail	Square Orders + Catalog API	Inherits Square's merchant base. Add Toast/Olo later if warranted.

Payment	Stripe Checkout / Square payment links	External checkout. PCI scope stays at zero.
Client (deferred)	Swift / SwiftUI	Phase 5+. Not required to prove the thesis.

Tool surface (v1)

get_menu · compose_order · place_order · get_order_status · get_profile · update_profile · get_history · submit_correction

07 Build Sequence

Each phase has a single definition of done. No phase begins before the previous one is verified working end to end.

PHASE 1 Server skeleton + one tool

Deploy a remote MCP server with OAuth 2.1 + DCR and a single tool, `get_menu`, reading a real Square catalog. Nothing else.

DONE WHEN — Claude and ChatGPT both connect to the server and return a real menu from a real merchant.

PHASE 2 The whole thesis

Add `compose_order`, `place_order`, and payment-link return. One local restaurant. Real order, real money, into their real POS.

DONE WHEN — ten consecutive orders placed by assistant land correctly and are paid for. Everything after this phase is elaboration.

PHASE 3 Profile & language

Add `get_profile`, `update_profile`, `get_history`. Store language, allergens, order history. Compose in one language, transmit in another.

DONE WHEN — an order spoken in a non-English language lands as correct structured English line items at the POS.

PHASE 4 Accuracy ledger

Add `submit_correction`. Receipt in, correction in, both tied to merchant, location, and item. Begin accumulation.

DONE WHEN — a queryable per-merchant accuracy record exists with real entries.

PHASE 5 iOS client

Swift app for profile custody, Apple Pay, receipt archive. Migration path toward user-held encryption keys.

DONE WHEN — profile is editable on device and syncs to the connector.

PHASE 6 Context detection

Geofenced drive-through detection and automatic merchant context loading.

DONE WHEN — entering a known drive-through pre-loads that merchant's menu.

08 Open Decisions

1. Profile custody — must be decided before Phase 3

MCP servers must be remotely reachable over HTTPS. ChatGPT therefore *cannot* read a profile that exists only on a phone. "On-device profile" and "AI connector" are architecturally opposed in v1.

Recommendation: ship v1 with the profile in Postgres keyed to OAuth identity, and design the schema so that a move to server-stored encrypted blobs with device-held keys is a migration rather than a rewrite. Treat the encrypted version as the product's public promise and the roadmap's next hard milestone.

2. Monetization — unresolved

The consumer will not add a third subscription. The merchant already receives ChatGPT and Claude ordering from Square for processing fees alone. The only defensible ask is a per-order fee justified by measurable accuracy improvement — which means **Phase 4 must exist before pricing can be set**. Do not attempt to sell this before the ledger has data in it.

3. Merchant acquisition beyond the first

Phase 2 requires exactly one willing restaurant. Phase 7 (unwritten) requires a repeatable reason for the second hundred to opt in. That reason is most likely the accuracy ledger, not the connector.

09 Non-Goals

- Competing with UCP, ACP, or MCP at the protocol layer
- Building or holding a payment rail; touching card data
- Scraping merchant websites for menu content
- Merchant-side voice AI or drive-through hardware
- Replacing Square, Toast, or any POS
- Delivery logistics

10 Principal Risks

RISK	MITIGATION
Platform absorption — Anthropic or OpenAI builds a native ordering memory	Make the profile user-owned, portable, and cross-assistant. The version they will not build is the one that works when the user leaves them.
Square extends into the customer profile	Unlikely — their incentive is merchant-side. But the accuracy ledger spanning multiple merchants is structurally hostile to any single POS company building it.
Connector security	Zero-click exfiltration vectors against MCP connector flows have been demonstrated publicly. This connector holds order history and initiates payments. Auth and tool-input validation are first-class design work in Phase 1, not cleanup in Phase 4.
Scope expansion	The concept broadened five times in a single planning session. The phase gates above exist specifically to prevent that. Phases ship in order.
Founder capacity	Rooted v38 is at the gate with blocker A8 unresolved. Spling Phase 1 does not begin until v38 ships.

Market facts in Section 03 reflect public information as of August 2, 2026 and should be re-verified before Phase 1 — this landscape moved substantially between January and July 2026 and will move again. Protocol requirements (OAuth 2.1, DCR, remote-HTTPS-only) should be confirmed against current OpenAI and Anthropic developer documentation at build time.